HUMAN RESOURCES & COMPANY POLICIES

Comprehensive Leave & Time-Off Policy

Apex Global Technologies Inc. — Annual Leave, Sick Leave, Statutory Holidays, and Workflows

Effective Date: January 1, 2026	**Version:** 3.4	**Classification:** Confidential — Internal	**Owner:** People Operations & Benefits

1. Policy Purpose and Guiding Philosophy

Apex Global Technologies believes that rest, recuperation, and personal time are critical to sustained engineering productivity, cognitive clarity, and overall well-being. This policy outlines entitlements, accrual rules, and approval procedures for all categories of leave.

2. Paid Time Off (PTO) / Annual Vacation Leave

Full-time permanent employees are entitled to paid annual leave to recharge and attend to personal matters:

- **Annual Entitlement:** Twenty (20) business days of paid vacation per calendar year (accrued at the rate of 1.67 days per full calendar month worked).
- **Accrual Commencement:** Accrual begins on the employee's first official day of employment. Leave may be requested once accrued.
- **Rollover Rules:** Up to five (5) unused PTO days may be carried over into the following calendar year. Any carried-over days must be utilized before March 31st of the new calendar year, after which they expire without cash payout, unless mandated otherwise by local employment regulations.
- **Separation Payout:** Upon voluntary separation or termination, accrued and unused PTO days are paid out in the final paycheck based on the employee's current daily base salary rate.

3. Sick and Medical Leave

Apex provides dedicated paid sick leave to ensure employees prioritize recovery without financial worry:

- **Annual Allowance:** Ten (10) paid sick days per calendar year, credited on January 1st (or prorated for mid-year joiners). Sick leave does not accrue month-by-month and does not roll over.
- **Medical Certificate Requirement:** If an employee is absent due to illness for more than two (2) consecutive business days, a verified medical certificate signed by a licensed healthcare practitioner must be submitted to People Operations upon return.
- **Emergency Medical Leave:** For prolonged hospitalization or critical health conditions, employees may apply for Short-Term Disability (STD) or Family and Medical Leave (FMLA), providing up to 12 weeks of job-protected leave.

4. Public and Company-Observed Holidays

Apex observes eleven (11) official paid company holidays each calendar year, plus two (2) personal Floating Holidays:

Holiday Observance	Standard Schedule	Operating Status
New Year's Day	January 1st	All Corporate Offices Closed
Martin Luther King Jr. Day	Third Monday of January	Corporate Offices Closed
Memorial Day	Last Monday of May	Corporate Offices Closed
Juneteenth National Independence	June 19th	Corporate Offices Closed
Independence Day	July 4th	Corporate Offices Closed
Labor Day	First Monday of September	Corporate Offices Closed
Thanksgiving Day & Day After	Fourth Thursday & Friday of November	Corporate Offices Closed (2 Days)
Christmas Eve & Christmas Day	December 24th & 25th	Corporate Offices Closed (2 Days)
Floating Holidays (2 Days)	Employee's Choice (Cultural/Religious)	Manager Notification Required

5. Parental, Family Care, and Civic Leave

- **Primary Caregiver Parental Leave:** Sixteen (16) weeks of 100% fully paid leave following the birth, adoption, or foster placement of a child. Available to all employees with at least 6 months of continuous service.
- **Secondary Caregiver Parental Leave:** Four (4) weeks of 100% fully paid parental leave, exercisable within 12 months of the qualifying event.
- **Bereavement Leave:** Up to five (5) consecutive paid days for immediate family members (spouse, child, parent, sibling); up to three (3) paid days for extended family.
- **Jury Duty & Civic Responsibility:** Up to ten (10) business days of paid leave to attend mandatory jury duty or legal witness subpoenas upon submission of the court summons.

6. Leave Application and Approval Workflow

Standard Leave Application Procedure

1. **Submission:** All leave requests must be logged through the BambooHR Self-Service Portal.
2. **Advance Notice:** For planned leaves of three (3) or more consecutive days, requests must be submitted at least fourteen (14) calendar days in advance. For single-day PTO, at least forty-eight (48) hours notice is required.
3. **Manager Approval:** Direct managers must review and act on leave requests within forty-eight (48) business hours. Managers may only decline leave in writing based on critical project release freezes.
4. **Unplanned / Emergency Absences:** In cases of sudden illness or emergency, notify your direct manager and post in your team's Slack channel before 08:30 AM local time.